

Zega Digital — WhatsApp Bot

Client Setup Guide

This guide lists everything **you (the client)** need to prepare on your side so your developer can connect and launch the Zega Digital WhatsApp bot. You already have the hard part done — a **Meta Business account with the WhatsApp API configured**. The remaining tasks are mostly collecting a few credentials, creating a **permanent access token**, and approving a couple of settings. None of this requires coding.

Roles: Tasks marked **[You]** are done by you in your Meta / Business account. Tasks marked **[Developer]** are done by your developer — listed only so you know what to expect. When you finish, hand your developer the checklist in Step 10.

Set aside about **30–45 minutes**, and have a password manager or secure note ready to store the values you collect.

Step 1 — Collect your WhatsApp API details **You**

Go to developers.facebook.com › **My Apps** › *(your app)* › **WhatsApp** › **API Setup**. Copy these two values:

- ☐ **Phone Number ID** — a long number shown under the sender number
- ☐ **WhatsApp Business Account ID (WABA ID)**

These identify which number the bot speaks through. They are not secret, but your developer needs them.

Step 2 — Get your App ID and App Secret **You**

Go to **your app** › **App Settings** › **Basic**.

- ☐ **App ID**
- ☐ **App Secret** (click *Show* — treat this like a password)

The App Secret lets the bot verify that incoming messages really come from Meta. Keep it private.

Step 3 — Create a **PERMANENT** access token **You**

This is the most important step. The token shown on the API Setup page **expires after 24 hours**. A live bot needs a token that never expires, created through a *System User*.

1. Go to business.facebook.com › **Business Settings**.
2. Under *Users*, click **System Users**.
3. Click **Add**, name it e.g. *Zega Bot*, role **Admin**, create it.

4. Click **Add Assets** › select your **App** and your **WhatsApp Account** › enable full control for each.
5. Click **Generate New Token** › choose your app › expiration **Never**.
6. Tick **whatsapp_business_messaging** and **whatsapp_business_management**, then **Generate**.
7. **Copy the token immediately and store it securely** — Meta shows it only once.

☐ Permanent access token generated and saved

Step 4 — Make sure billing is set up **YOU**

WhatsApp charges per conversation, billed to your business account. In **WhatsApp Manager › Billing / Payment settings**, confirm a valid payment method is attached.

☐ Payment method confirmed

Step 5 — Confirm your phone number is ready **YOU**

In **WhatsApp › API Setup** (or WhatsApp Manager › Phone numbers):

- ☐ The number for the bot is listed and its **display name is approved** (status *Connected* / green tick)
 - ☐ While testing, add your **testers' phone numbers** under the recipient list — during testing the bot can only message numbers added there
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Step 6 — Business verification (for full public launch) **YOU**

You can skip this while testing. To message the general public at scale you need a **verified business**. Go to **Business Settings › Security Center** and complete verification.

☐ Business verification complete (or planned before public launch)

Step 7 — Provide a privacy policy URL **YOU**

Meta requires a privacy policy for live messaging apps. A simple page stating that the bot provides digital-literacy education and does not store personal conversations is enough.

☐ Privacy policy URL ready (e.g. on your website)

Step 8 — Approve the reminder templates (optional) **YOU + DEVELOPER**

Only needed if you want the bot to **send daily reminders** to inactive users — the core lessons work without this. Your developer submits 3 message templates; you may need to review them in **WhatsApp Manager › Message templates**. Approval takes a few hours to a day.

☐ (Optional) Reminder templates reviewed / approved

Step 9 — Decide a few things **YOU**

Quick decisions your developer will ask about:

- ☐ **Which phone number** the bot runs on (test number vs. your real number)
- ☐ **Languages** to launch with (English is ready; Amharic / Afaan Oromo can be added)
- ☐ **Reminders** on or off at launch
- ☐ **Who pays for hosting** (a small monthly fee, roughly \$0–10) and approval to set it up

Step 10 — Hand off to your developer YOU

Send the following to your developer **securely** — use a password-manager share or an encrypted note, **not** plain email or chat:

Phone Number ID: _____
WhatsApp Business Acct ID: _____
App ID: _____
App Secret: _____ (secret)
Permanent access token: _____ (secret)
Verify token: (developer can choose, or pick a random phrase)
Privacy policy URL: _____
Phone number / display name: _____

Security note: the App Secret and permanent token give full control of your WhatsApp messaging. Share them only with your trusted developer, store them in a password manager, and regenerate them if they ever leak.

What happens next DEVELOPER

Your developer will: (1) deploy the bot to a hosting service that provides a public web address; (2) enter your credentials there as configuration; (3) update your **Webhook** in the Meta dashboard to point at that address and subscribe to the messages field; (4) test by messaging your number, then hand it over. Once that is done, anyone messaging your WhatsApp number gets the bot.